Bajaj responded, 'Mr Gill, how dare you! You are behaving in an obnoxious manner, go away from here.'[6] When Gill persisted with his request, Bajaj pulled her chair back, creating enough room to exit between her chair and the chair of one of the women sitting next to her (who was Mrs Bijlani, the wife of the managing director of a company that manufactured machinery). As Bajaj rose from her chair and turned to leave, Gill slapped her on the bottom.

Bajaj was furious and determined not to let this pass. Her initial response was to approach her host Kapur, who was standing on a paved platform adjacent to the lawn. Unrepentant, Gill followed Bajaj on her way to speak to Kapur. She told Kapur that Gill was not fit for decent company, that he had misbehaved with her, and that he had gone to the extent of hitting her. Together with another guest, Kapur then physically escorted Gill away from the lawn and into the house. Bajaj also narrated the incident to G.C. Pathak, the joint director of the IB, who was standing by. Pathak promised that he had made a note of this incident and would report it to the relevant authorities within the central government.

Bajaj was congratulated by the other women for her fortitude in dealing with Gill's conduct. When she informed her husband about what had happened, his instinct was to pursue Gill at that moment. She restrained him from doing so, particularly since members of the press were present. Bajaj later recounted that as they were leaving, she overheard one of the other guests deplore Gill's behaviour from that evening: 'This man made me feel like vomiting.'[7] Even as many of the guests left the party with a bad taste in their mouth, most of them would have expected that what happened at the Kapur residence would stay in the Kapur residence. There was a tacit understanding that these elite gatherings were meant to be closed to the outside world, misbehaviour or not.

Bajaj had other ideas. She was determined on seeing Gill reprimanded for his misconduct. Since they were both members of the civil service, Bajaj thought that disciplinary action against Gill by the government (rather than criminal proceedings) would be the swiftest and most effective response. She approached R.P. Ojha, chief secretary of Punjab and 'blue eyed boy'[8] to